

(Adyar), Tata Medical Center in Kolkata, and Basavatarakam Indo American Cancer Hospital in Hyderabad offer comprehensive oncology services. For example, Bhagwan Mahaveer Cancer Hospital in Jaipur provided free blood cancer treatment to 199 children in 2022 and allocated ₹7.28 crore in 2020–21 for treating below-poverty-line patients. Charutar Arogya Mandal's Shri Krishna Hospital performs over 500 cancer surgeries annually and administers chemotherapy and radiotherapy to thousands of patients, highlighting the significant role these hospitals play in bridging access gaps.

CAPITAL ISSUES

Cancer care is attracting unprecedented investment, driven by rising disease burden, shifting demographics, and growing demand for advanced therapies. According to FICCI, the overall market, including drugs, diagnostics and treatment facilities, is valued at ₹1.25 lakh crore (approximately \$15 billion) and is projected to grow 10–12% annually. The oncology segment alone is estimated at around ₹30,000 crore, witnessing double-digit growth of 13–14% nationwide.

India's oncology sector is attracting over ₹10,000 crore in committed investments from private hospitals, diagnostics, and pharmaceutical/biologics companies. Including other incremental and unspecified investments, total inflows could reach ₹12,000–13,000 crore, reflecting strong confidence in the sector's growth potential.

Apollo Hospitals is investing ₹2,000 crore between 2025 and 2028 to expand Tier-II/III centres and develop a proton therapy facility in Gurugram. Max



“The burden of this disease is as much in Tier I cities as in smaller districts. So investment in this speciality has been made across the country”

VISHAL BALI
EXECUTIVE CHAIRMAN, ASIA
HEALTHCAREHOLDINGS

Healthcare and Fortis Healthcare are earmarking ₹1,200 crore and ₹1,000 crore, respectively, for hospital expansion and technology upgrades, including oncology services. Aster DM Healthcare is planning to invest ₹600 crore for cancer specialty units, while Manipal Hospitals plans to allocate ₹1,500 crore for oncology-focused blocks, including a 100-bed cancer centre in Bhubaneswar. HCG and Omega Hospitals are also expanding networks and research hubs, showing widespread private-sector confidence in oncology.

Investments extend beyond hospitals. Diagnostics companies are scaling up capabilities to support early detection and precision medicine. Metropolis Healthcare is undertaking minor rolling capex in 2025–26 for lab upgrades, Agilus Di-

agnostics is investing around ₹250 crore till 2027 for molecular and pathology labs, and Dr. Lal PathLabs is making incremental investments through 2028 to strengthen high-complexity oncology testing.

Pharmaceutical and biologics players are also expanding. Sun Pharma has committed \$100 million (around ₹850 crore) in FY26 for specialty and oncology product commercialisation, including UN-LOXCYT, while Biocon and Biocon Biologics are investing around ₹1,200 crore till 2027 for manufacturing expansion and global distribution of oncology biologics.

Analysts say India's oncology market represents a significant long-term opportunity. “Cancer care is one of the fastest-growing tertiary care segments, driven by rising prevalence, shifting demographics, and patient demand for advanced therapies,” says Srimayee Chakraborty, Partner – Healthcare Services, EY Parthenon India. She notes that leading single- and multi-speciality providers focused on oncology often see growth exceeding 20%.

Sunil Thakur, Partner and Investment Committee Member at Quadria Capital, says “cancer care in India addresses one of the largest unmet healthcare needs. While official figures report over 1.5 million new cases annually, the actual incidence may be closer to 2.5–2.7 million. This gap, combined with infrastructure expansion, advanced therapies, and diagnostics, creates a compelling growth story.” Thakur also points out that capital-intensive treatments such as PET-CT scanners, linear accelerators, and molecular labs offer high utilisation under day-care models. **BT**

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